

Limiting Beliefs Worksheet

Identifying and challenging limiting beliefs — evidence questions, reframing techniques, and a way to test a new belief through action, not just thought.

A limiting belief here means an everyday assumption about yourself that quietly shapes what you attempt (“I’m not a numbers person,” “I always freeze in interviews”) — not a clinical concern. If working through this brings up something that feels bigger than a specific belief about a specific situation, that’s worth bringing to a therapist or counselor rather than working through alone.

1. Limiting Beliefs Identification

A limiting belief is an assumption you treat as fact, even though it’s really just one interpretation — and one that happens to hold you back from something you actually want.

Common Categories

Category	Example
Capability	“I’m not a natural public speaker”
Worthiness	“I haven’t really earned this opportunity”
Permanence	“I’ve always been disorganized — that’s just who I am”
Others’ judgment	“People will think less of me if this doesn’t work out”

Identification Prompts

- What do I tell myself I can’t do, or am not the kind of person who does?
- What excuse do I reach for most often when I decide not to pursue something?
- What would I attempt if I were certain I couldn’t fail at it?
- Where does this belief show up across more than one area of my life?

Your Beliefs

Area of Life	The Belief (in your own words)	How Often It Shows Up
Example: Career	“I’m not the kind of person who gets promoted”	Every performance review cycle

2. Evidence Challenge Questions

Beliefs feel like facts, but most limiting beliefs don't hold up well once you actually look for evidence on both sides — not to prove yourself wrong, but to see the fuller picture your original belief left out.

Questions to Ask

- Is this belief 100% true, in every situation, without exception?
- What real evidence actually supports this belief?
- What evidence contradicts it, even if I've been discounting it?
- Would I say this to a friend who was in the exact same situation?
- Is there a more accurate, more balanced way to describe what's actually true here?

Your Evidence Table

Pick one belief from Section 1 to work through here first.

The Belief	Evidence For	Evidence Against	A More Balanced Statement
"I'm not the kind of person who gets promoted"	Passed over once last year	Received strong feedback on two major projects; manager has said I'm ready for more responsibility	"I haven't been promoted yet, and there's real evidence I'm being considered for it"

3. Reframing Techniques

Reframing isn't about forcing positivity over a real problem — it's about restating a belief more accurately, since the original version is usually more extreme than the evidence actually supports.

Technique	Example
Absolute → Conditional	"I always fail at this" → "I've struggled with this in some situations, particularly when I'm unprepared"
Identity → Behavior	"I am a failure" → "That specific attempt didn't work, and I can learn something from it"
Permanent → Changeable	"I can't change" → "I haven't yet found an approach that works for me"
The "yet" Reframe	"I'm not good at this" → "I'm not good at this yet"

Reframe Your Belief

Original Belief	Reframed Version
"I'm not the kind of person who gets promoted"	"I haven't been promoted yet, and I have real evidence I'm being considered for it"

4. Action Planning Section

A reframed belief becomes real through a small action that tests it, not just through thinking about it differently — treat this like a genuine experiment: predict what you expect, then check what actually happens.

Reframed Belief	Small Action to Test It	What I Predict Will Happen	What Actually Happened	What I Learned
"I haven't been promoted yet, and I have real evidence I'm being considered"	Ask my manager directly what specifically would need to be true for the next promotion cycle	They'll be vague or discouraging		

Reflection

After completing your action, what surprised you about the actual result compared to your prediction?

Revisit this worksheet for beliefs as they come up — the goal isn't to eliminate every limiting belief in one sitting, but to build the habit of noticing and testing them as they appear.